Republic of the Philippines
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
BANGSAMORO TRANSITION AUTHORITY PARLIAMENT
Bangsamoro Government Center, Cotabato City

FOURTH REGULAR SESSION

PARLIAMENT RESOLUTION NO. 565

RESOLUTION URGING HIS EXCELLENCY, PRESIDENT FERDINAND R. MARCOS JR., TO AUTHORIZE, AS A SPECIAL AND TIME-BOUND MEASURE, THE ZERO-TARIFF DIRECT IMPORTATION OF RICE FROM SABAH, MALAYSIA, EXCLUSIVELY FOR THE PROVINCE OF TAWI-TAWI, IN ORDER TO REDUCE RICE PRICES, ENSURE FOOD SECURITY, AND ALLEVIATE THE HARDSHIP FACED BY THE PEOPLE OF TAWI-TAWI

WHEREAS, the Province of Tawi-Tawi is a geographically isolated, island-based province located far from the country's major rice-producing areas, rendering it highly dependent on shipped-in supplies to meet its staple food requirements;

WHEREAS, Section 1608 of Republic Act No. 10863, also known as the *"Customs Modernization and Tariff Act (CMTA)"*, empowers the President, upon the recommendation of the Economy and Development Council, to modify import duties;

WHEREAS, Executive Order No. 105 (s. 2025) provides for an administrative review by the Secretary of the Department of Economy, Planning, and Development (DEPDev) to address specific economic and developmental needs;

WHEREAS, the people of Tawi-Tawi are presently dependent on rice supplies sourced from Zamboanga City and other distant domestic ports, where high shipping, fuel, handling, and logistics costs significantly increase the landed cost of rice in the province, thereby imposing a serious burden on households, particularly low-income families and vulnerable sectors, and exacerbating food insecurity and economic hardship;

WHEREAS, Sabah, Malaysia is geographically closer to the Province of Tawi-Tawi than mainland Philippine supply points, making it a more practical and cost-efficient potential source of rice, if lawfully and properly authorized by the National Government;

WHEREAS, the Republic of the Philippines is a participating member of the Brunei Darussalam–Indonesia–Malaysia–Philippines East ASEAN Growth Area (BIMP-EAGA), a subregional cooperation initiative established to promote economic integration, cross-border trade, food security, and development in geographically isolated and border areas of its member states;

WHEREAS, the Province of Tawi-Tawi forms part of the Philippine participation area under BIMP-EAGA and is strategically positioned to benefit from lawful and regulated cross-border trade arrangements consistent with the objectives of said initiative;

WHEREAS, allowing the lawful, regulated, and zero-tariff direct importation of rice from Sabah, Malaysia, exclusively for the Province of Tawi-Tawi and subject to national government oversight, would reduce logistics costs, stabilize rice supply, and significantly lower consumer prices, without the need for costly transshipment through distant ports;

WHEREAS, this proposed measure is intended as a special, time-bound, and humanitarian intervention to address food security concerns in a geographically disadvantaged area, and does not recognize, condone, or legitimize any informal or unauthorized trade;

WHEREAS, the State has the constitutional duty to ensure food security, protect consumers, and promote the general welfare, particularly in geographically isolated and disadvantaged areas such as the Province of Tawi-Tawi:

NOW, THEREFORE, be it

RESOLVED, as it is hereby resolved by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament, To urge his excellency, President Ferdinand R. Marcos Jr., to authorize, as a special and time-bound measure, the zero-tariff direct importation of rice from Sabah, Malaysia, exclusively for the Province of Tawi-Tawi, in order to reduce rice prices, ensure food security, and alleviate the hardship faced by the people of Tawi-Tawi.

RESOLVED, FURTHER, That such authority be exercised with appropriate national government regulatory safeguards, and with reasonable limitations as to volume, duration, and intended destination.

RESOLVED, FINALLY, To furnish copies of this Resolution to the Office of the President of the Philippines, the concerned national government agencies, and the Provincial Government of Tawi-Tawi, for their information and appropriate action.

ADOPTED, *Rajab* 30, 1447/January 19, 2026

Certified Correct:

PROF. RABY B. ANGKAL
Secretary-General

Attested:

MOHAMMAD S. YACOB
Speaker

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